10.17 Breast Cancer and Mastectomy*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I do not want to see my chest." **Objective** • Mastectomy 2 days ago • Looks away during dressing changes	**ACTUAL** Disrupted body image related to loss of a breast as evidenced by refusal to look at the surgical site.	• Before discharge, looks at the incision and discusses options.	• Encourage her to express her feelings. • Offer to be with her when she first looks at the site. • Discuss prosthesis and reconstruction. • Offer referral to a support group.	• Considered met when she has looked at the site and discussed options.
Subjective • Rates pain 5/10 **Objective** • Chest incision • Wound drain in place	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to surgical tissue trauma as evidenced by a pain score of 5/10.	• Pain at or below 3/10.	• Give analgesia as prescribed. • Rest the arm on a pillow. • Check that the drain works and record the output.	• Goal reached when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Axillary lymph node dissection	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: axillary node removal with impaired lymphatic drainage of the arm.	• No infection or lymphedema of the arm.	• No BP readings, injections or blood tests on the affected arm. • Reinforce the prescribed arm exercises. • Teach skin care and protection from cuts and burns. • Ask her to report arm swelling or redness.	• Met if there is no infection or swelling.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.